

■ By Devayani Shahane

The glamour industry has walked the distance in its pursuit of excellence—even though the journey hasn't always been on snazzy stilettoes. Four models from the past and present—Mehr Jessica Rampal, Anna Bredmeyer, Diana Penty and Sanea Sheikh—embody the transformation. Former supermodels, 39-year-old Jessica, married to actor Arjun Rampal and mother to Mahika and Myra; Bredmeyer, married to horse-trainer Dallas Todiwalla and mother to 15-year-old Stephan, talk about the beauty boom as they have lived it, along with 21-year-old Penty and 20-year-old Sheikh who are living it now. Excerpts from a debate on the changing definitions of making a mark in the model marketplace.

Earlier, classic beauties and those with great bodies stood out. What is the trend right now?

Anna Bredmeyer (AB): In our time, everyone had an individual style which meant self confidence. Today all models are being cloned, maybe because designers dictate the look and the presentation. Now models look as if they are on a funeral march. But I believe you can stand out.

Mehr Jessica Rampal (MJR): For advertising cam-

paigns, the classic beauty look is in while for the ramp, it is still about the right height, attitude and style.

Diana Penty (DP): It's the whole package—decent face and body but also style and attitude.

Sanea Sheikh (SS): Attitude and style are both crucial but it is individuality that sets a model apart.

Are unconventional, dusky looks in?

AB: I don't think any particular look is in. The look is standardised and everyone looks similar.

DP: The dusky and unconventional look has always worked. Perhaps it is more accepted now compared to earlier times when classic beauties ruled.

SS: Unconventional looks have always been accepted and will continue to be.

Do you think getting work was more challenging then as compared to now?

AB: I was spotted in 1973 when I was still in school. My first campaign was for Sunsilk and then it was Hindustan Thompson. If you were good, work came your way.

MJR: We always had a lot of work and used to take seven to 10 days to rehearse for a show—a far cry from today when girls don't want to practice.

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that models
were paid
by top brands
in 1973

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